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Private K-12 Education in Morocco

Market overview & opportunity analysis for brand-licensing partners

Ellesmere College International

Refreshed from ECI internal Draft 1.2 (July 2025) with 2025-26 enrolment, fee, competition, and regulatory updates.

Executive summary

Morocco presents a high-potential growth market for partners building under the Ellesmere brand. The private K-12 sector is large and urban, less mature than the Gulf, and shaped by rising demand for English-medium and British pathways among upper-middle families.

About 1.27 million students attend private schools in 2025-26 (roughly 15% of national enrolment). Published international tuition in Casablanca typically clusters around a mid-60s MAD thousand median. American and IB premiums sit well above; French mission schools remain the value benchmark.

British provision has expanded in Greater Casablanca, Rabat, and Tangier. The opportunity is differentiation on UK heritage brand, pastoral quality, and a clear MAD 60,000-90,000 mid-premium position - not an empty market. Priority locations: Rabat, Bouskoura / Casablanca suburbs, and Tangier.

Key takeaways

- 1.27M private students nationally in 2025-26; demand concentrated in the Casablanca-Rabat corridor.
- Mid-premium MAD 60-90k sits between French value and American/IB ultra-premium pricing.
- Compete on brand depth and quality assurance; BISC, London Academy, and Cambridge-linked schools are active.
- Law 59.21 raises fee transparency and annual contract standards - favourable for reputable operators.
- Primary partner model: brand licensing. Curriculum/advisory are optional add-ons.

Macro overview

Population is approximately 38.4 million (2025), with a young age structure and urbanisation around two-thirds. Ministry figures for 2025-26 report 8.27 million enrolled students: about 7.00 million public and 1.27 million private. Private share has risen over the past decade, with schools heavily clustered along the Casablanca-Kenitra axis.

Policy context includes the 2022-2026 education roadmap and Law 59.21, which requires written annual parent-school contracts, published fee lists (including ancillary services), and prohibits in-year fee increases. Foreign curricula may be offered subject to authorisation and national identity programme requirements.

Tuition benchmarking

Indicative annual tuition (published schedules / aggregators, 2025-26 and 2026-27). Confirm total cost locally.

- Value / French mission: approx. MAD 40,000-55,000 (e.g. Lycee Lyautey ~40.8k-48.2k).
- Accessible British / bilingual: approx. MAD 36,000-70,000 (e.g. London Academy Casa ~36k-69k).
- Mid-premium international (ECI alignment): MAD 60,000-90,000; Casa international median ~MAD 66.5k.
- Premium American / IB: approx. MAD 90,000-175,000+ (CAS, GWA published ranges).

A licensed Ellesmere school in the MAD 60-90k band targets families trading up for English pathways without paying ultra-premium American/IB fees.

Competitive landscape

French provision still dominates private international enrolment. English-medium and British pathways have grown materially. Partners should assume active competitors in Casablanca's orbit.

- Casablanca: French lycees; American/IB (CAS, GWA, American Academy); British options including BISC, London Academy (Bouskoura), and ISM.
- Rabat: fewer full British Nursery-Y13 campuses; American and French incumbents; London Academy also present.
- Tangier: Cambridge-linked options (e.g. Everest) and Anglo-Moroccan provision; lighter mid-fee British density than Casa-Rabat.
- Differentiation: UK independent-school heritage, pastoral/character education, network QA, transparent mid-premium

pricing.

Priority destinations for partners

Rabat - Very High: capital visibility, diplomatic/professional families, strong cultural fit for a UK-heritage flagship.

Bouskoura & Greater Casablanca suburbs - Very High: affluent residential growth and deliverable sites. British competitors are present; win on brand depth and campus quality, not 'first British school' alone.

Tangier - High: industrial and logistics-led professional growth; clear second-wave British heritage opportunity.

Central Casablanca is selective (scale but saturation). Marrakesh, Agadir, Temara-Sale, Fes, and El Jadida suit later network phases or partnership-led entry.

Location targeting snapshot

- Rabat: High scale | Strong income | Medium competition | Very High opportunity
- Bouskoura / Casa suburbs: Medium-High | Strong | Medium | Very High
- Tangier: Medium-High | Rising | Low-Medium | High
- Central Casablanca: Very High | Strong | High | Medium
- Marrakesh / Agadir: Medium | Moderate | Medium/Low | Moderate
- Temara-Sale: Medium | Moderate | Low | High (overflow)
- Fes / El Jadida: Medium-Low | Lower | Low | Watchlist

How partners engage

ECI's primary offer is brand licensing: investors and operators build and run a school under the Ellesmere name, with curriculum frameworks, quality assurance, leadership support, and network governance. Curriculum and advisory services are optional add-ons - not parallel products.

- Capital and operating partners fund campus delivery and local operations.
- ECI licenses brand and standards; protects quality across the network.
- Plan Arabic / cultural programmes alongside British pathways.
- Fee transparency and annual parent contracts are baseline regulatory expectations.

Outlook

Morocco combines demographic scale, urbanising affluence, and a private sector that already educates more than a million learners - yet English-medium mid-premium British provision remains thinner than in mature Gulf markets. For capital partners, Morocco is both a near-term campus opportunity and a long-term North African platform under a single licensed brand.

Selected sources

- Ministry of National Education 2025-26 enrolment (reported via Morocco World News / Express TV).
- Law 59.21 private school transparency framework (SNRT / La Releve reporting).
- International Schools Database - Casablanca published fee schedules 2025/26-2026/27.
- doris - Casablanca international tuition medians (2026).
- men.gov.ma; hcp.ma.

Disclaimer: For qualified investor and operator partners. Figures are compiled from public sources and may change; they are not a prospectus or fee quote. Confirm regulation, licensing, and school-level fees locally before investment decisions. Ellesmere College International.